SET UP REEL STUDIO IN ONE EVENING

You bought a creative director. This is how you move it in. Two ways to do it, pick one.

OPTION 1 · LET CLAUDE INSTALL IT

Download the zip, open the folder in Claude Code, type "build my studio". Pages 2 to 4.

OPTION 2 · STEP BY STEP, BY HAND

Prompt by prompt, you drive every step. Pages 5 to 8.

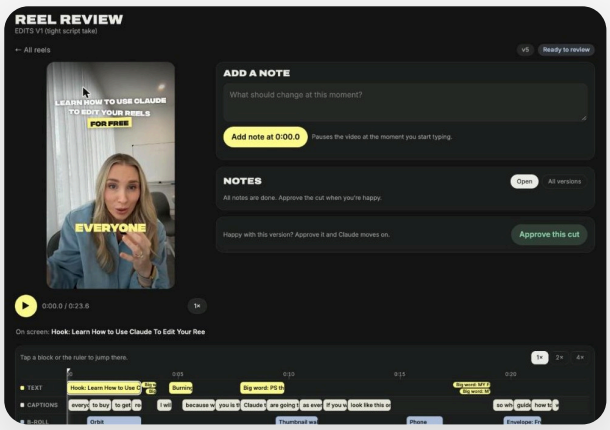
DOWNLOAD THE KIT

reel-studio-kit.zip · 15 MB · Mac and Windows · version 0.9.0

ON A WINDOWS PC? READ THIS FIRST

Windows setup guide · 4 pages

That link is yours. Please don't share it; the price goes up for everyone else when the next templates land.



1 Get Claude Code
10 min

2 Unzip the kit, open the folder
2 min

3 Type "build my studio"
20 to 40 min, mostly waiting

4 Your first reel
15 min

5 Review by timestamp
5 min, then every time

BEFORE YOU START, YOU NEED

- [ ] A Mac (Apple silicon or Intel, macOS 14 or newer) or a Windows 10 or 11 PC (64-bit Intel or AMD). On Windows, a few effects that cut you out of the shot run in a simpler version. The Windows guide has the details.
- [ ] The Claude desktop app, signed in to a plan that includes Claude Code (Pro or Max).
- [ ] About 3 GB of free space and a normal internet connection. The first run downloads the speech model (1.5 GB).
- [ ] 45 minutes where you can leave the computer awake.

HAVE THESE HANDY, CLAUDE WILL ASK

Your brand colours as hex codes, or just your website address. Claude can read the colours off it.

Your fonts if you own the files. Skip this if you don't; it renders with fonts every Mac already has.

Three to six of your own reels you're proud of, saved to a folder. Claude reads them to learn your style.

Your Instagram handle. It goes on the DM and follow cards.

1 GET CLAUDE CODE

Claude Code is the part of the Claude app that can run things on your Mac, not just chat. It lives in the desktop app under a tab called **Code**. If you already use the Claude app, you may have it and not know.

DO THIS

1. Download the Claude desktop app from **claude.com/download** and sign in.
2. Click the **Code** tab in the left sidebar. If you don't see it, your plan doesn't include Claude Code yet. Pro or Max does.
3. Leave it open. Come back after step 2.

Two things Claude can't install for you because they need your Mac password: Apple's free developer tools and Node. Claude will tell you if either is missing and give you the one line to run. Both are safe, free, and take a few minutes. You only ever do this once.

2 UNZIP THE KIT AND OPEN THE FOLDER

The kit is a folder. Everything lives inside it: the engine, your brand file, your reels, your finished cuts. Put it somewhere permanent, because you'll be dropping footage into it every week.

DO THIS

1. Click **Download the kit** on page 1 of this guide. Find **reel-studio-kit.zip** in your Downloads and double-click it. A folder called **reel-studio-kit** appears.
2. Drag that folder to your home folder (the one with your name on it) or your Documents. Don't rename anything inside it.
3. Back in the Claude app, Code tab: choose **Open folder** and pick **reel-studio-kit**.

WHAT YOU'LL SEE
An empty chat with the folder name at the top. That's correct. Claude has already read the instructions in the folder.

IF YOU SEE A PERMISSIONS QUESTION
Claude asks before it touches anything outside the kit. Say yes to the kit folder itself.

WHAT'S IN THE FOLDER

INBOX
Drop raw footage here. Claude moves it into a project when you say "cut this".

PROJECTS
One folder per reel: your raw takes, the transcript, the plan, the finished MP4.

BRAND
brand.json (your colours and fonts), fonts (yours, if any), refs (your example reels).

TEMPLATES
Two starting reel formats, the editor's brief Claude works from, and the brand guide builder.

ENGINE
The renderer. You never open this. Claude does.

EXAMPLES/SMOKE
The 10 second test reel the installer renders to prove everything works.

3 TYPE "BUILD MY STUDIO"

This is the whole install. Claude runs the installer itself, then interviews you one question at a time and writes your brand file from the answers. Here is what happens, in order, so nothing surprises you.

TYPE EXACTLY THIS

```
build my studio
```

WHAT CLAUDE DOES, IN ORDER

Installs the tools. It says this takes 5 to 25 minutes and runs the installer. Text scrolls. Leave it. If it stops and asks you to install Apple's developer tools or Node, do that, then say "done" and it carries on.

Renders a test reel and opens it. You should see captions, one yellow line and a big word behind the speaker. Say yes if you do.

Asks your name and handle. The handle goes on DM and follow cards.

Asks for your colours. Give hex codes, or your website address, or a screenshot of your brand board. Claude asks before it reads any of them, then shows you four colours and what each is for: punch, accent, paper, ink. Say yes or change one.

Asks about fonts. Say "skip" and it uses Avenir Next and Georgia, which are on every Mac. Or tell it where your font files are. It asks before it opens that folder.

Asks for your reels. Point it at a folder of 3 to 6 reels you're proud of. It copies them in and uses them to match your style.

Runs a taste test. About 20 rounds of three effects in your studio. Tap the one you would want in your reel, or none. Three minutes, no wrong answers.

Re-renders the test reel in your brand and opens it. Then it asks you for one change, so you learn the loop. Ask for bigger captions or a different punch colour and watch it come back.

The rule Claude follows: it asks before it reads anything outside the kit folder, it never asks for passwords, and if something fails twice it stops and tells you what's wrong instead of looping. You can say "stop" at any point.

IF THE INSTALL STOPS

"Xcode command line tools are missing." Open Terminal from Spotlight, paste **xcode-select --install** , click Install in the dialog, wait, then tell Claude "done".

"Node is too old" or missing. Go to nodejs.org, download the macOS installer, run it, then tell Claude "done".

Download stalls. Say "run the installer again". Finished steps are skipped.

HOW LONG, HONESTLY

Installer: 5 minutes on a fast connection, 25 on a slow one. The 1.5 GB speech model is the long part.

The questions: 10 minutes if your colours and reels are ready.

Test renders: about a minute each.

Then it's yours. Nothing in this step ever needs doing again.

4 YOUR FIRST REEL

Film the way you always do. Everything after that happens in your studio, a page in your browser.

DO THIS

1. In Claude Code, in your Reel Studio folder, type **/edit**. Your studio opens. Leave the Claude window open in the background.
2. Tap **+ New reel** and drag your footage in. Say what the reel is about in a line, then pick a style. Tick **Same as last time** to reuse your last look, or **Cut first** to keep or cut each line before any styling.
3. Read the plan: the hook, every line and the effect on it. Tap **Yes**, or type a change. In a hurry, tap **Just cut it**.
4. Check your numbered moments. Preview any one in seconds, leave a note on it, then tap **Looks good, render it**. Download the reel and post.

5 REVIEW BY TIMESTAMP

Watch the cut all the way through before you say anything. Then tap the second you want changed and type the note, on your computer or your phone (same Wi-Fi).

NOTES LOOK LIKE THIS

Hook is slow, start on "I spent 25 hours". Caption lags here. Lose this line. Put the screenshot here.

Or tap any block on the timeline to move it, stretch it, colour it or take it out, and tap a caption word to fix it. Or tap a Quick fix. Send your notes together and version 2 lands with each one ticked off. Every version is kept. **Reel-Studio-What-To-Say.pdf** in your folder has the phrases that work best.



THE FIVE RULES CLAUDE EDITS BY

01 Cut 20 to 30% off the raw take. Lose any line that can go without losing meaning.

02 Every effect earns its place. A word on screen triggers it: a name gets a label, a number gets a counter, a place gets the b-roll.

03 Captions big, and a beat early. Never on the face.

04 Proof for every name and number. No asset, no claim.

05 Every word on screen is yours. It comes out of what you said in that reel and out of your own call to action, never out of an example.



ALYCIA CHAPMAN

I run a podcast production studio in Brisbane. Every show we've made has topped the charts, 4.5 million downloads between them. I built Reel Studio because I was tired of paying an editor per clip, and tired of chat windows. It cuts my own reels every week.

STUCK?

Tell Claude what happened and paste any error. Most things are a one-line fix. Still stuck: type **update Reel Studio**, then **send a help note**.

Post the first reel and tag **@alyciachapman_**.

MAKE IT YOURS.

Two reels cut by two people who have never met should not look related. The look stays put: your fonts, your colours and where your captions sit are set once and left alone. Everything else is a decision, and every decision is a sentence you can type. These are real ones. Copy them.

ASK TO BE OFFERED, NOT TOLD

YOU TYPE

Before you plan, run the menu command and show me the options: the hook you'd use, what you'd cut, and a short list of effects you think fit, each one with the line it would sit on. Name them the way I'd say them, not the code names. I'll pick.

You get a numbered list, not a finished cut described out loud. Pick two or three and ignore the rest. Eight a minute is the ceiling, not the target.

PUT ONE EFFECT ON ONE LINE

YOU TYPE

Put the cards spinning around my head on the line where I say "Notion, Descript and Canva". Nothing else changes.

OR

Open library/effects-library.html so I can see them all. Then use "a wall of photos" where I say "every client we have ever had".

Every effect has a name you would actually say out loud, printed under it on that page. Ask by that name and it works.

CHANGE WHAT YOUR WORDS LOOK LIKE

YOU TYPE

Use the file in brand/fonts called Integral-Heavy.otf as my display font, for the hook, the big words and the end card. Put it in brand.json and re-render my last reel so I can see it.

OR

Put my captions in a box for this one, the wall behind me is too bright.

OR

Make "embarrassing" the yellow word, not "shocked".

Font and colour go in your brand guide and hold for every reel after. The box and the yellow word are per reel.

TEACH IT HOW YOU ASK

YOU TYPE

I never want to ask for comments. I want people to DM me the word BLUEPRINT, and the card should say "and it lands in your inbox tonight". Write that into brand/voice.json and use it from every reel on.

OR

I don't want a call to action at all. My reels end on the point. Put that in brand/voice.json.

This is the file that stops your reels sounding like anybody else's. Your end card, your DM line and the words on your cards come out of it and out of what you actually said in that reel. Claude is stopped before you ever see a cut that borrows somebody else's.

STOP IT REPEATING ITSELF

YOU TYPE

My last two reels both opened the same way. Open this one differently and tell me what you picked and why.

OR

That's too much. Keep the three effects that sit on something I actually said and drop the rest.

Claude keeps a note of what your last few reels opened with and is told to open the next one another way. Ask for the list any time: `what did my last three reels open with?`

OR SKIP ALL OF IT

YOU TYPE

Don't ask me, just cut it. Afterwards tell me which effects you chose and the line each one sits on.

Same on the review page: tap **just cut it** when you drop the footage. You still get the reasons, so the next one is a conversation about real choices instead of a blank page.

WHAT NEVER CHANGES

Every cut is measured before you see it: captions off your face, text that holds against what is behind it, no colour that is not yours, and no word borrowed from anyone else.

OPTION 2: PROMPT BY PROMPT.

Same result as "build my studio", but you drive every step and see every decision. Open the kit folder in Claude Code and type these in order. You never open Terminal. The same script is in the kit as **PROMPTS.md**, so you can copy and paste.

1 SET IT UP AS YOUR EDITOR

YOU TYPE

I am going to set you up as my reel editor. Read this folder. Tell me what you need installed on this Mac to edit reels, then install it. Assume this Mac has nothing installed yet. Ask me before you install anything outside this folder.

Claude: lists what it needs (Node, Apple's developer tools, Remotion, Whisper, the cutout tools), tells you the two it can't install without your password and the one line to run for each, runs the installer, renders a test reel and opens it. **You:** say yes if you see captions, a yellow line and a big word behind the speaker.

2 YOUR BEST REELS

YOU TYPE

Here are my reels that I love and that were edited well. Ask me where they are, copy them into brand/refs, and tell me what you notice about the editing: caption style, where text sits, how often something changes, what the hooks do.

Claude: asks where, asks permission to read that folder, copies them in, writes back what it sees. **No edited reels yet?** Type: "I don't have edited reels of my own yet, skip to the ones I love from other people."

3 REELS YOU LOVE FROM OTHER PEOPLE

YOU TYPE

Here are reels from other people whose style and look I love. Ask me where they are, copy them into brand/refs/inspiration, and tell me what they have in common. Don't show me examples; work from what I give you.

Claude: works only from what you give it. This is where your taste gets written down.

4 YOUR BRAND

YOU TYPE

Now my brand. Ask me for my colours and my fonts. If I don't have them, ask me questions until you can suggest three options, mock each one up as a still from my test reel so I can see A, B and C, and let me pick. Then write brand/brand.json and show me the rules in plain words.

Claude: if you have fonts, asks where the files are and copies them into brand/fonts. If you don't, it uses fonts every Mac has and renders three colour options from your own test reel. You pick one.

5 YOUR EFFECTS

YOU TYPE

Open library/effects-library.html so I can see every effect and the name to say out loud. Then look at the reels in brand/refs and tell me which ones you'd use to recreate what I love, and on what kind of line each one sits.

Claude: maps what you love to the studio's effects (page 9 has the whole list). From now on "a number counting up" or "one giant word behind my head" just works, and Claude offers them to you by those names rather than waiting to be asked.

6 YOUR WORDS

YOU TYPE

Ask me how I want my reels to end. Whether I want people to comment a word, DM me, follow, click something or none of it, and the exact way I'd write that ask in my own words. Then ask me the words I always say, the words I'd never put on screen, and how I usually open. Write it to brand/voice.json and read it back to me.

Claude: asks, writes it down once, and uses it on every reel after. "Nothing at all" is a real answer. Your look is shared with everyone who bought this kit on purpose; your words are the part that must not be.

7 YOUR BRAND GUIDE

YOU TYPE

Interview me for anything you still don't know, one question at a time, then write my reel brand guide to brand/guide/reel-brand-guide.html using templates/brand/BRAND-GUIDE-BUILDER.md as the structure. Read it before every edit from now on.

Claude: asks only the gaps, writes the guide, and reads it before every cut. This is the thing that makes the reels yours.

8 YOUR REVIEW STUDIO

YOU TYPE

Build me my review studio. Look at templates/brand/studio-reference.jpg: a reel beside its notes, with text, captions, b-roll, cards, moves, cuts and notes each on a timeline I can tap, and an approve button. Follow templates/brand/REVIEW-PAGE.md to build it as my own private page and wire the engine so every cut you render lands there. Then show me the link.

Claude: builds the page you saw on page 4 inside your own Claude account, private to you, and wires the engine to publish every cut there. Open the link on your phone and save it to your home screen.



9 YOUR FIRST REEL

YOU TYPE

I've put raw footage in inbox. Cut this. Before you plan, run the menu command and show me the options: the hook you'd use, what you'd cut, and a short list of effects you think fit, each with the line it would sit on. Name them the way I'd say them. I'll pick.

Claude: transcribes every word, offers the menu, waits. **You:** say yes or change the hook. Then watch the cut on your phone and give notes by timestamp: "0:04 hook is slow. 0:19 caption lags. 0:31 lose this line." Claude fixes each, tells you what changed, renders version 2.

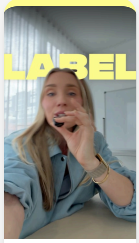
IF CLAUDE EVER STALLS

Type: **Stop. Tell me in one sentence what is wrong and the one thing I need to do.** It will. Fix that one thing and carry on from the same prompt.

EVERY EFFECT IN THE STUDIO.

All 48. Each is triggered by something you say: a name, a number, a place, a list, an ask. Every one has a name to say out loud, printed under it in **library/effects-library.html**; the fields are in **templates/skill/EFFECTS.md**.

- Text and type
- Proof on screen
- Numbers and data
- Lists and steps
- AI and apps
- Asks
- Moves and hits



bigword

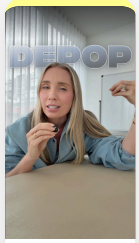


label


header



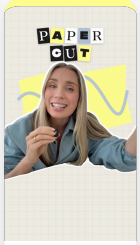
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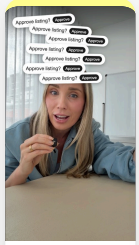
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burn

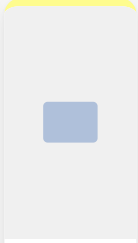


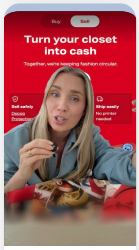
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pills



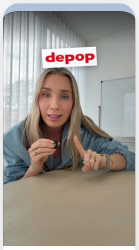
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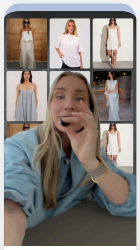


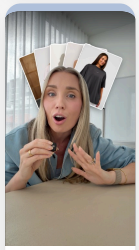
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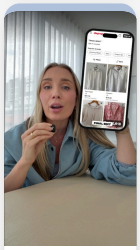


sticker


wall

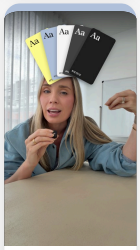

deck


orbit


phone

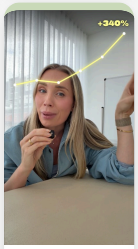

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annotate

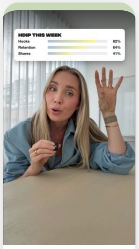

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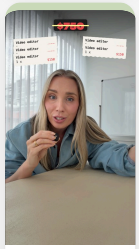
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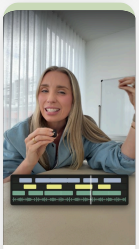


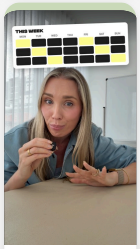
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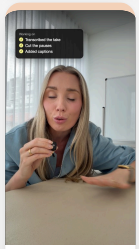

statbars


dial


receipts


timeline

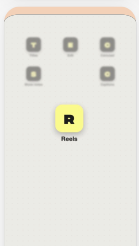

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tasks



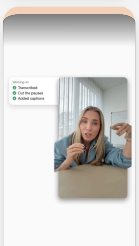
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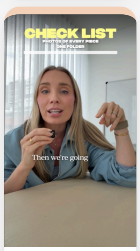

flow



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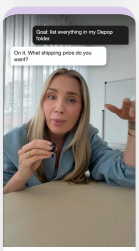

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pullback

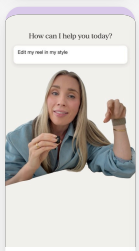


checklist

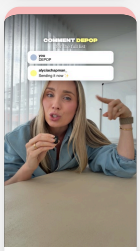

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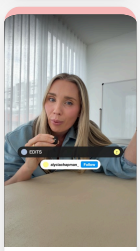

chat


folder

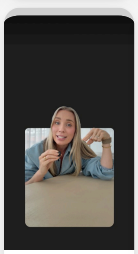


uiworld


dm

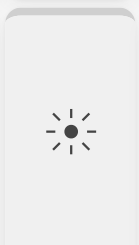

comment

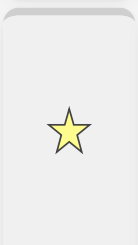

doodle


framebreak


rip

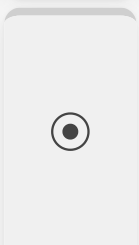

glitch


zoomblur


flash


dzoom


vertigo


zoomthrough